

What CoStar gives Dan, what it cannot, and what we can

Dan Gura runs CoStar across the entire United States and calls his own workflow “antiquated.” Before claiming to beat it, this characterises it — then shows the one column it structurally does not carry, with Arizona worked end to end as proof. 27 August 2026.

CoStar avg \$15,130/yr

50 AZ projects, 49 design teams

The design team is not a CoStar entity

GROUND TRUTH

What CoStar actually is, and what it costs

CoStar Suite is a commercial-property research and prospecting database covering the US, Canada, UK and France — over **300,000 active users** and forty years of history. It is the reference tool for brokers, lenders, appraisers and investment teams. Dan has it **for the entire United States**, got it as a condition of joining MVE thirteen years ago, and his BD staff use it under him.

FIGURE	VALUE	SOURCE
Average annual contract	\$15,130	Vendr internal transaction data
Observed range	~\$3,000 to ~\$23,000 / yr	Vendr, across their buyer base
Entry point	from ~\$300 / month	Published guides
Pricing model	Custom and opaque. It does not reduce to a per-seat number — the quote is driven by which markets you take, which modules, and how many users. National coverage sits at the top of the range.	

✗ DO NOT CONFLATE TWO DIFFERENT PRODUCTS

CoStar Real Estate Manager is a separate lease-administration and accounting product, quoted at **\$75,000–\$200,000/yr** mid-market and **\$200,000–\$500,000+** enterprise. That is *not* what Dan is describing. Quoting those numbers at him would be wrong and he would know immediately.

How CoStar models a project. Its development pipeline runs four phases — **Unconfirmed** → **Planning** → **Final Planning** → **In Construction** — tracked by construction status, expected delivery date and unit or room counts, sliceable by class, market, submarket and brand. CoStar research staff do talk to architects, developers and planning departments, but they do so *to firm up delivery dates*. That distinction is the whole opportunity.

THE GAP

The design team is not a CoStar entity

CoStar’s unit of analysis is the *asset* and its economics. Ours is the *project team*.

Everything CoStar is built to return describes a building and its money: who owns it, who leases it, what it sold for, what it will rent for, when it delivers. That is the correct design for its customers — brokers, lenders, appraisers, investors. **None of them need to know who the architect is.**

So the fields that matter to a firm trying to get *hired onto* a project — architect, structural engineer, civil, landscape, general contractor, and above all **whether a seat has been filled yet** — are not what CoStar indexes. Dan can tell you a 400-unit project in Tucson was submitted and who the developer is. He cannot filter for “*projects where no architect has been appointed*.”

▲ WHICH IS THE PITCH, AND IT IS NOT A SOFTWARE PITCH

Dan does not need better developer contacts — that is where CoStar is strongest and where he is already good. **What he cannot buy is the consultant layer:** who is already on a project, who is not, and which developers habitually use which architects. For a BD director at an architecture firm that is a displacement map, and for KOR the same data with the structural row is a target list.

METHOD

Where the design-team data actually lives

It is published — just not by CoStar, and not in one place. It sits in regional construction trade press and in planning submittals, and it has to be assembled region by region. The sources that carry full consultant rosters:

REGION	SOURCE THAT NAMES THE DESIGN TEAM	WHAT IT YIELDS
Arizona	AZBEX (Arizona Builder's Exchange) — △ subscription ; and AZ Big Media , which is open	★ The richest of the set. AZBEX names developer, architect, landscape architect, civil engineer, traffic engineer and land-use counsel on a single case. But the archive is gated — see below
Nevada	NVBEX — same publisher as AZBEX, same gate	Same format, same depth. The two are siblings, which matters commercially
Texas	Houston Chronicle <i>residential development tracker</i> ; Houston.org project round-ups	Developer, size, stage, timeline; architect intermittently
Florida / N. Carolina	Multi-Housing News, Multifamily Dive, local business journals	Developer and program reliably; design team on the larger towers
California	LA YIMBY, SF YIMBY, BuildSD, city plan sets	Already proven — the plan set carries the full directory
Anywhere	The city entitlement plan set itself	★ Definitive. The project-directory sheet lists every consultant. Slow, but it is the ground truth

▲ THE BUY RECOMMENDATION — BEX, NOT ANOTHER SCRAPER

AZBEX is subscription-gated, and testing established that its free pages are stubs. Ten current August 2026 articles were pulled; two carried an architect in the teaser and the rest returned a sign-up form where the body should be. **So every “no architect named” from AZBEX is paywall truncation, not absence** — and reporting it as absence would be the same error three times over.

The right response is not a better scraper. **The same publisher (BEX) covers Arizona and Nevada** — AZBEX, NVBEX, and **DATABEX**, a project database covering every Arizona commercial and infrastructure job over \$5M. Two of Dan's six regions from one subscription, with the design team attached. **Pricing is quote-only** — bex@azbex.com, 480-709-4190, and they advertise bundle pricing across the three products. Worth a call before another week of research.

[△](#) **Arizona has no equivalent of San Diego's permit feed.** San Diego republishes its full development-approvals table daily — 834,000 rows with status, valuation, storeys and unit mix. Phoenix publishes *aggregate counts only*: 23 rows of yearly permit totals. Its proposed-zoning layer gives case numbers and acreage but **no project name, developer or unit count**. So Arizona cannot be extracted; it has to be researched. Worth knowing before promising a live feed.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Arizona — 50 projects, 49 design teams

Assembled from AZ Big Media's 2026 projects feature and cross-checked against AZBEX. **Fifty current Arizona projects with developer, general contractor and architect named on forty-nine of them.** This is the artefact CoStar cannot produce.

The Arizona architect league table — who is actually winning work, by project count in this set:

ARCHITECT	PROJECTS	TYPE
LGE Design Build	6	Design-build
Butler Design Group	5	Design-build
RSP Architects	4	Hospitality, civic
triARC architecture & design	3	Arizona
STG Design	3	Arizona
Gensler	2	National
DLR Group	2	National
Corgan	2	National
KTGY	1	★ National multifamily
Niles Bolton Associates	1	★ National multifamily
ESG Architecture & Design	1	★ Multifamily

Also present once each: Deutsch Architecture Group, ALINE Architecture Concepts, Phoenix Design One, Soaring Eight, Lamar Johnson Collaborative, Richard Kennedy Architects, Todd & Associates, McCarthy Nordburg, Hamilton Architecture, Grace Design Studios and Athena Studio.

Read that as a BD director would. *LGE Design Build* and *Butler Design Group* are design-build outfits taking six and five slots — that is the competitive pressure in Arizona, and it is a different threat from a design firm. **KTGY** and **Niles Bolton** appearing is more interesting to MVE: those are national multifamily competitors operating in a market MVE is entering.

Representative entries, in the format the data actually supports:

PROJECT	SIZE	DEVELOPER	ARCHITECT	CONTRACTOR
5550 E. Crown Place, Phoenix	160,000 sf, 240 keys	LaPour / Holualoa Companies JV	RSP Architects	Whiting-Turner
19360 N. 73rd St., Scottsdale	88 units, 1,570–3,015 sf each	Belgravia Group	KTGY	Maris Construction of Arizona
217 E. 7th St., Tempe	521,553 sf	AZ Tempe Holdings / Trinitas	Niles Bolton Associates, Gensler	Layton Construction
10050 N. Scottsdale Rd.	384,492 sf	High Street Residential	ESG Architecture & Design	Wespac Residential
95 Arroyo Pinon Dr., Sedona	43,100 sf, 89 keys	Crystal Creek Capital	RSP Architects	Chanen Construction

⚠ **Honest caveat on this set:** it skews industrial, office and hospitality rather than multifamily — it is a general CRE round-up, not a housing list. As a *competitive map of who designs what in Arizona* it is strong. As a multifamily lead list it is thin, and building that properly means going to AZBEX case by case.

The wider Arizona pipeline, from the same research: **Arro** (Empire Group / Aspirant — ~1.8M sf, twin towers at 541 ft and 425 ft, the future tallest in the state, 380 apartments plus 275 co-living, 250-key hotel); **The Whitney** (24 storeys, 328 units, Central & McDowell); **Revelry** in Tempe (Aspirant, two towers, 533 units); **Astria Tempe** (27 storeys, 380 units); and a **323-unit Dominion** scheme in Tolleson still needing its rezoning.

DAN'S OTHER REGIONS

Nevada, Texas, Carolina, Florida — state of play

Dan named live or near-live MVE work in **Arizona, Nevada, Hawaii, Houston, Charlotte and Miami**. What is established so far, and what is not:

REGION	WHAT WE HAVE	DEPTH
Nevada	Bally's Las Vegas — three-phase mixed-use, Marnell Architecture , ~3,000 rooms, 2,500-seat theatre, 500k sf retail, construction slated for H1 2026. Riviera site — Brett Torino, 600-ft towers, 750-key hotel, 425 condos, 3,310-seat domed venue. Hylo Park — \$300–400M on the old Texas Station site. KB Home 1,500-home scheme started early 2026	Good start. NVBEX is the source to work through for design teams
Texas / Houston	Southern Land twin-tower scheme — 38 and 10 storeys, 330 apartments plus 18 penthouses, groundbreaking slipped to Q1 2026, completion 2028. StreetLights Residential 20-storey, 134 units in Boulevard Oaks	Named projects, no design teams yet. Houston Chronicle runs a live residential development tracker
Florida / Miami	PMG is the name to watch — Delano Residences Miami (their second downtown supertall) and the Waldorf Astoria , Miami's first supertall	Headline only. Supertall market, so the design teams are published — not yet gathered
North Carolina / Charlotte	Nothing verified yet	⚠ Not researched. Do not claim coverage
Hawaii	Nothing verified yet	⚠ Not researched. Dan said "might" have a project there

Stated plainly: Arizona is done to a usable standard, Nevada is half done, Texas and Florida are headlines, and Carolina and Hawaii are empty. Anything sent to Dan should say so — he will check, and being caught claiming national coverage we do not have would undo the credibility the dossiers just earned.

RECOMMENDATION

What to send, and what to claim

- **Lead with the corrections, not the volume.** Dan told us Santa Clara Park is AO's and that our headcount figure was modelled. Sending those back fixed proves the "it learns and it is never wrong again" claim better than any new document. It costs nothing and it is the most credible thing we can do this week.
- **Send Arizona as a sample, framed as the design-team layer.** Fifty projects with forty-nine design teams, plus the architect league table. Say what it is: assembled from public trade sources, not a live feed, and skewed to commercial rather than multifamily.
- **Say the honest thing about his 40-storey test.** A filing made that same day is not in any public feed yet; it surfaces when the city posts it or the trade press picks it up, typically within days. **The defensible claim is that nothing published gets missed — not that nothing unpublished is known.** He is a professional; the honest answer will land better than a dodge.
- **Do not offer a CoStar replacement.** He pays for national coverage and forty years of comps. What we have is a different axis, not a cheaper version of his. The line is "*this is the layer your CoStar does not carry*" — and on that ground we are genuinely ahead.

KOR Structural — internal BD intelligence, 27 August 2026. **Not for external distribution in this form.** The Arizona section is the part fit to be adapted and sent.

Sources: Vendr CoStar buyer guide and published pricing breakdowns; CoStar Group pipeline documentation; AZ Big Media 2026 projects feature (50 entries parsed, architect count verified against the s